

HOOVERING IT UP

In 1907, an American caretaker called James Spangler invented a small, portable cleaner. It had a rotating brush and an electric fan to move dust, a pillowcase to collect it, and a broom handle to move the device around. Spangler sold his device's rights to the American businessperson William Hoover, who would build one of the world's leading vacuum cleaner companies making improved versions of Spangler's invention.

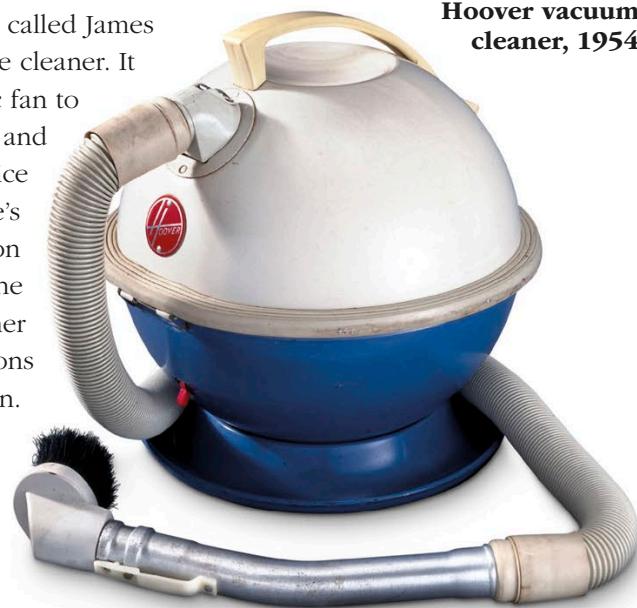
A futuristic-looking Hoover vacuum cleaner, 1954



THE DYSON CLEANER

For much of the 20th century, vacuum cleaners used cloth bags to collect the dust, but the fuller the bags got, the weaker power to suck up dust became. In 1979, the British inventor James Dyson (see pp.202–203) came up with a new type of bagless vacuum cleaner, called a cyclonic vacuum cleaner (right).

The G-Force, Dyson's first widely sold cyclonic vacuum cleaner, 1990



Brushes at front sweep up dust



ROBOT CLEANERS

In the 2000s, a number of robot vacuum cleaners reached the market. These devices are fitted with sensors that automatically guide them around objects, such as pieces of furniture, while they suck up dust. The first one to go on sale was the Electrolux Trilobite (above) in 2001.

CYCLONIC VACUUM CLEANER

In a cyclonic vacuum cleaner, rotating fans create a vacuum that sucks dust-filled air into the machine. The air then passes through a series of cone-shaped devices called cyclones where it's spun around very fast, separating the dust from it. This dust falls into a dust collection bin, which is emptied when full, removing the need for a bag.

